



The Cretaceous

The third and final period of the Mesozoic was the Cretaceous. It was the **longest** of the three periods, but it didn't last forever...

Many dinosaurs developed horns and armour during the Cretaceous.

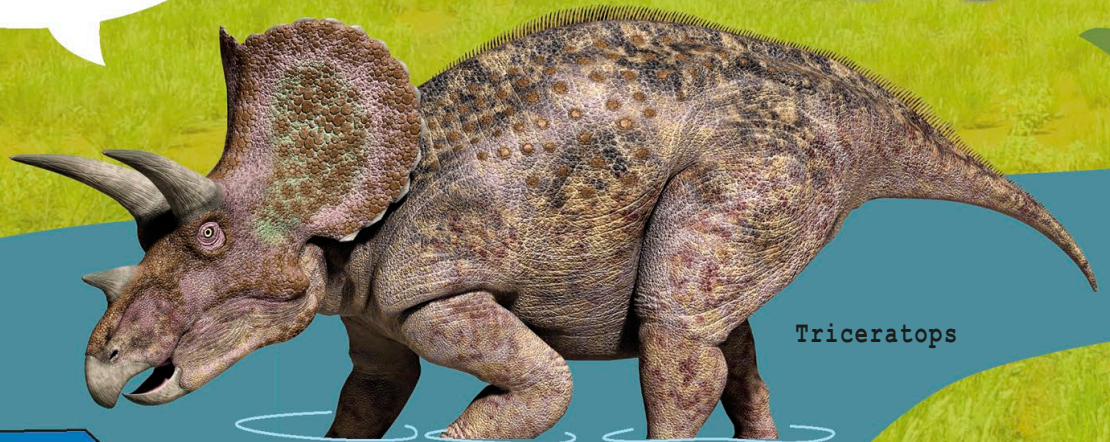
Flowering plants appeared for the first time during the Cretaceous.



Amargasaurus



Iguanodon



Triceratops

CRETACEOUS PERIOD

145–66 million years ago

The dinosaur boom

The Cretaceous was the peak of the dinosaurs time on Earth. It was during the Cretaceous that many new dinosaurs appeared, including the famous **Tyrannosaurus** and **Triceratops**.